



New Intel on AI advantage with open standards

Sachin Katti talks NVIDIA partnership, India's chip dreams and more

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At Intel's Tech Tour 2025 in Phoenix, Arizona, during the launch of Panther Lake chips, I got a chance to sense what the new Intel is all about through my exclusive conversation with Sachin Katti, Intel's new Chief Technology and AI Officer. Intel seems to be at a historical cusp unlike ever before. All eyes are now on Intel's actions, not its words. I ask Katti if he feels the magnitude of it all.

"The whole industry is at an inflection point," he says. "For Intel doubly so, because it needs to reinvent itself for the new computing landscape and as a company, as a foundry plus a products business. That sense of urgency is there every single day."

He smiles. "But you live for these moments. As a technologist, this is what you want to be doing. These moments don't come that often."

New Intel = Discipline

Katti's read on the moment is pragmatic yet ambitious. "We are building a new Intel centered on engineering, innovation, and disciplined execution," he says. "Fab 52, Intel 18A and Panther Lake aren't just milestones. They are foundational to the future of AI computing."

Intel's bet isn't just "more GPU." It's a systems-level rethink of how AI is built and deployed – from agents on PCs to inference farms to training frontier models. Katti's central idea: a shift

from homogeneous "all-GPU" architectures to heterogeneous systems that pair the right silicon for each phase of agentic AI workflows.

"We strongly believe the architecture for the future of AI is heterogeneous," says Katti. "A zero-friction way of deploying agentic AI applications that automatically orchestrate across infrastructure to deliver better performance per dollar."

Intel's orchestration software decides which compute engine to use based on the workload – optimizing memory-bound or compute-heavy tasks, keeping costs low. "When I say heterogeneous, I also mean open," Katti adds. "We'll support multiple vendors' infrastructure. An open software approach lets us insert disruptive technologies into this architecture."

To prove it's real, Intel demonstrated Llama running prefill on an Nvidia GPU and decode on an Intel accelerator, coordinated by Intel's stack. "We saw nearly a 1.7x improvement in performance per dollar compared to homogenous systems," says Katti.

The NVIDIA alliance

For Katti, AI is a "systems game" – CPUs, GPUs, networking, optics, and memory all working in concert. Intel's partnership with NVIDIA, once unthinkable, now fits this worldview. "Our open software ensures that when

we come out with our GPUs, it's not like the software locks us up," Katti explains. "This partnership is the first step of our AI strategy."

That strategy includes a predictable product rhythm. "We need to get onto an annual, predictable cadence of GPUs," Katti says. The first wave targets inference workloads with higher bandwidth and capacity, while Intel's bets on photonics and memory stacking aim to "overcome the bandwidth wall that exists in AI today" – opening the door to frontier model training.

India's semiconductor frontier

On India's semiconductor ambitions, Katti is supportive but clear-eyed. "India is a super important market for us – it has several decades of growth ahead," he says. "Given the geopolitical situation, fab and process technology are national security issues. We remain very engaged with the Indian government and partners like Tata."

For Intel, being both a products powerhouse and a foundry means it can help India build capacity while supplying chips designed on 18A – a strategic duality that adds strength.

In Katti's view, the PC is now part of a larger agentic mesh – sometimes the first hop, sometimes the last. If Intel's bet on openness, cadence, and heterogeneity works, your laptop could soon become an active participant in AI's vast, distributed brain. 